



Hop On - Hop Off Guide

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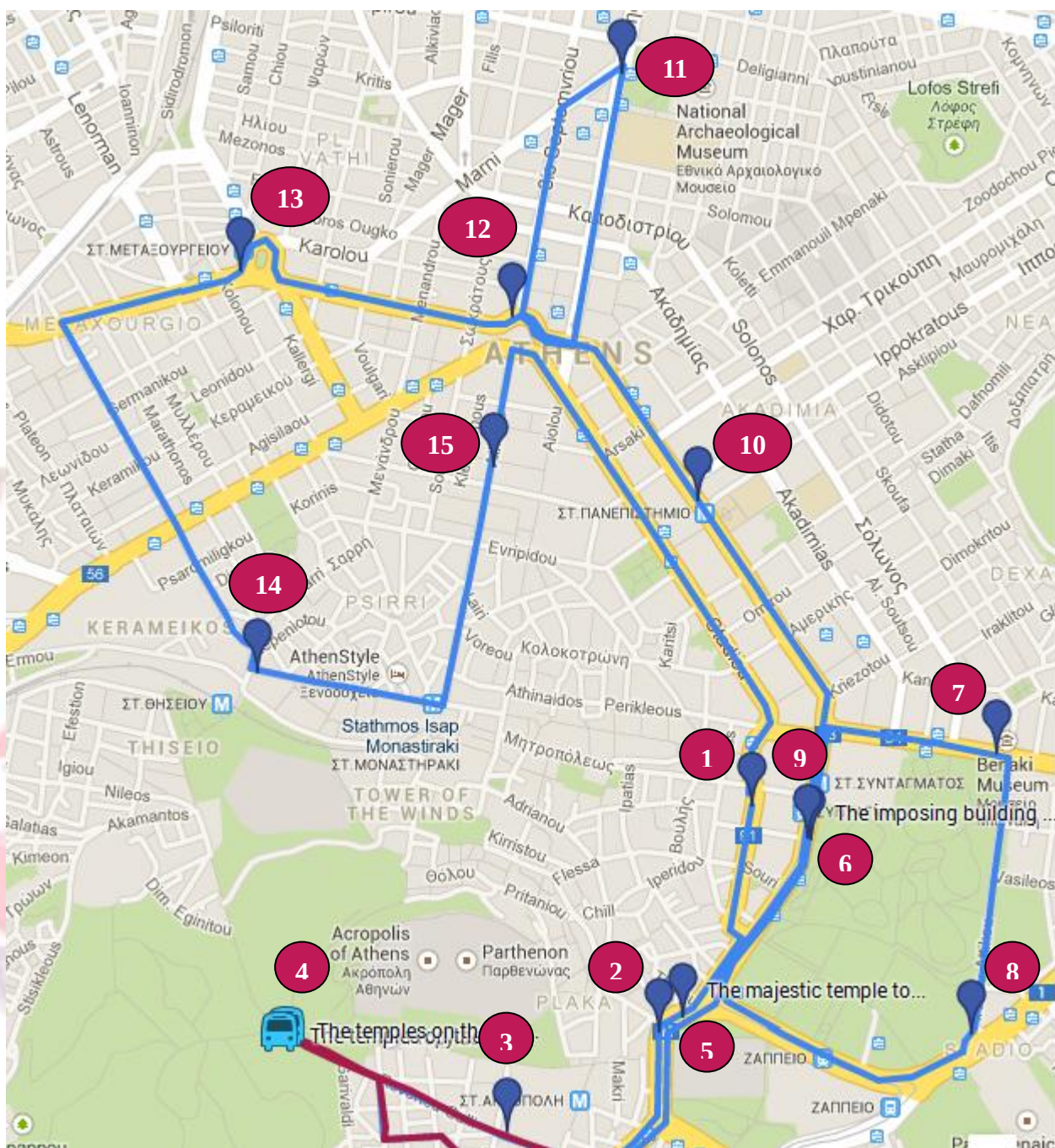
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Tour map



Syntagma Square

(Line 2 & 3-Syntagma Metro Station)

Bus Stop
1

- ✓ Visit the museum of the central **Metro Station**. It features a variety of historical items unearthed during the process of building the metro.



- ✓ Walk the **Hermou Str.**, the commercial street of the district. With fashion shops and shopping centers promoting most international brands, it is in the top five most expensive shopping streets in Europe and the tenth most expensive retail street in the world. One of the oldest churches in Athens, the Byzantine **Church of Panaghia Kapnikarea** is in a small square, on the east section of Hermou Street.

- ✓ Explore the little restaurants, wine bars and cafés in the streets that cross Hermou Str.



Melina Merkouri / Plaka

(Line 2-Acropolis Metro Station)

Bus Stop
2

- ✓ **The bust of Melina Merkouri:** She was the lady who started the campaign to repatriate the marbles of the Parthenon from the British museum back to Athens.
- ✓ The walk for pedestrians, which goes all around the Acropolis, starts from here and ends to Thissio. It is the most beautiful walk of Athens and one of the most beautiful walks of Europe.
- ✓ **Plaka** is the old district of Athens with beautiful old houses, narrow streets, small stores, little restaurants and remains of the ancient town. **Tip:** have a cup of coffee or tea in “Giasemi”, a small taverna in a special corner in Plaka (23 Mnisikleous Street, Plaka).



Plaka



Giasemi



Brettos bar

- ✓ **Brettos bar:** This old tavern is a real classic in Plaka. It deserves a visit even if you don't drink, just to see its old wooden interior, with those huge barrels and all the lighted bottles on the walls (41 Kidathineon, Plaka).

New Acropolis Museum

(Line 2-Acropolis Metro Station)

Bus Stop
3

- ✓ **Acropolis Museum:** an imposing building that was designed with a double purpose: to display the masterpieces of antiquity and to show the dialectical relationship with the Parthenon, one of the major monuments of the global cultural heritage. The museum is essentially suspended above the excavation, offering the visitor an impressive view of the ancient remains. Glass floors, impressive statues and the Parthenon gallery will impress you.



- ✓ **Acropolis Museum Café & Restaurant:** You could have a rest at the museum's restaurant on the second floor, with panoramic view of the Acropolis and a 700 square meter public terrace commanding a breathtaking view of the historic hills of Athens.

Acropolis and Parthenon

(Line 2-Acropolis Metro Station)

Bus Stop
4

- ✓ **Acropolis:** The Acropolis hill (acro - edge, polis - city), so called the "Sacred Rock" of Athens, is the most important site of the city and constitutes one of the most recognizable monuments of the world. It is the most significant reference point of ancient Greek culture, as well as the symbol of the city of Athens itself as it represents the apogee of artistic development in the 5th century BC.

Visit the Parthenon, the masterpiece of architecture, the Erechtheion with the beautiful porch of Caryatids, the small temple of Athena Nike and the Propylaia, the monumental entrance.



- ✓ **Odeon of Herodes Atticus:** It was built in 161 AD and used as a venue for music concerts with a capacity of 5,000. It was destroyed in 267 AD and restored in 1950s. Since then it has been the main venue of the Athens Festival, which runs from May through October each year, featuring a variety of acclaimed Greek as well as International performances.

Among the artists who have performed at the Odeon of Herodes Atticus include Maria Callas, José Carreras, Montserrat Caballé, the Bolshoi Ballets, Maurice Béjart, Joaquín Cortés, Frank Sinatra, Diana Ross, Lisa Minnelli, Goran Bregovic, Jean Michel Jarre and Ennio Morricone.

Temple of Zeus

(Line 2-Acropolis Metro Station)

Bus Stop
5

- ✓ **Temple of Zeus:** Is a colossal temple in the center of Athens. The construction started in the 6th c. BC but it was completed in the 2nd c. AD by the Roman Emperor Hadrian. The temple had 104 Corinthian columns in ancient times but only 16 of them remain today. Inside there was a colossal statue of Zeus made out of irony and gold.



- ✓ **Arch of Hadrian:** Outside the temple of Zeus there is the Hadrian's Arch which was also built in the 2nd c. AD.



National Gardens (1)

(Line 2 & 3-Syntagma Metro Station)

Bus Stop
6



- ✓ **National Gardens:** These were originally known as the Royal Gardens. They were sponsored by Queen Amalia and were planned by a team of landscape designers, architects, sculptors and gardeners. This is one of the most pleasant and interesting parks of Greece with an enormous variety of trees, plants and flowers.



Benaki and Cycladic Museum

(Line 3-Evangelismos Metro Station)

Bus Stop
7

- ✓ **Benaki Museum:** It is an elegant neoclassical mansion constructed at the end of the 19th c. It was enlarged and embellished at the beginning of the 20th c. It was turned into a museum in 1930. It is one of the most interesting museums of Athens. Displayed in the main building is the historical and cultural development of Hellenism, from its origins to modern times, through art and artifacts.



- ✓ **Cycladic Museum:** This well-restored neoclassical mansion was built in 1885 by the architect Ernst Ziller. The ornate circular porch facing the corner with the stately entrance to the mansion is an unusual touch. It houses the Goulandris Museum of Cycladic and Ancient Greek art. The main collection consists of the characteristic stylized marble figurines, vessels as well as other artifacts from the Early Bronze Age culture (3000-2000 BC) of the islands of Cyclades.



- ✓ Proceed up Koumbari str. to Kolonaki Square where you can find cafés, small restaurants, bars, galleries and clothing and shoe stores.



- ✓ **Panathenaic Stadium:** It was built in 1896 for the first modern Olympic Games. It is all made out of marble and it is standing on the site of the ancient stadium which was built in the 4th c. BC for track events in the Greater Panathenaia festival. The stadium today is the finishing point for the contemporary Marathon race.



- ✓ You can also visit the little **museum** of the Olympic torches from all over the world which is inside the stadium.



- ✓ The **Discus Thrower**, a statue of 1924, raising a discus high above his head, was made by the sculptor Demetriadis.



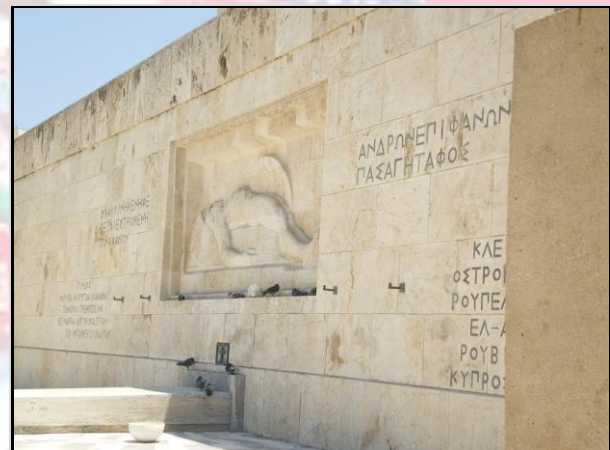
National Gardens (2)

(Line 2 & 3-Syntagma Metro Station)

Bus Stop
9



- ✓ **House of Parliament:** It is the old royal palace where the constitution was proclaimed from its balcony in 1843. That is why the name of the square is “Syntagma”, which means constitution. Since 1935, it is the House of Parliament. In front of the House there is the memorial of the Unknown Soldier.



- ✓ Watch the **changing of the guards** in front of the House of Parliament which is every hour on the hour.

National Library

(Line 2-Panepistimio Metro Station)

Bus Stop
10

- ✓ The trilogy of Athens consists of the **Academy**, the **University** and the **National Library**. They were designed and built by the prominent 19th century Danish architects, Christian Hamsen and his brother Theofilos. The “Trilogy” serves as an introduction to Athenian neoclassicism, a marvelous work of great beauty for the new capital of Greece.



- ✓ Walking towards Syntagma Square, on the right hand side of Venizelou Str. there is the **Attica department store** and the most well-known designers' stores all around the same block. Walk through the gallery of this block and you will find some nice cafés and restaurants for your lunch break.



Archaeological Museum

(Line 1 & 2-Omonia Metro Station)

Bus Stop

11

- ✓ **National Archaeological Museum:** The most interesting museum of Greece with beautiful collections from the Stone Age to the Roman period. Visit the exhibition of the shipwreck of Antikythera. Among the treasures of this exhibition are the remains of the most complex scientific object, the mechanism of **Antikythera**, which is an ancient Greek computer that has been preserved from antiquity.



- ✓ **National Technical University of Athens** is among the oldest and most prestigious higher education institutions of Greece. It was founded in 1837 as a part-time vocational school named Royal School of Arts which developed into Greece's sole institution providing engineering degrees. Its traditional campus, located in the center of the city of Athens on Patission Avenue, features a suite of magnificent neo-classical buildings. A suburban campus, the Zografou Campus, was built in the 1980s.

- ✓ The area of **Exarcheia**, dominated by the Athens Polytechnic and its famous band of anarchists, is a bohemian district with lots of bars and clubs visited by students, intellectuals and people who are into alternative culture.

Omonia Square

(Line 1 & 2-Omonia Metro Station)

Bus Stop
12

- ✓ **Omonia Square:** During the Belle Époque and early 20th century, numerous hotels were built around it like the “Bangeion” and the “Alexander the Great”, designed by the architect Ziller, still standing today.

The meaning of the word “Omonia” is “Concord”, to mark the national unity.



- ✓ The area near Omonia is buzzing with life. A mixture of all cultures can be found there. Near the square are a number of small flea markets, exotic imported goods and food, and some nice small streets with restaurants and cafes.

Karaiskaki Square

(Line 2-Metaxourghio Metro Station)

Bus Stop
13

- ✓ In the middle of the square there is a modern sculpture representing **Icarus**, the son of the master craftsman Daedalus. The main story told about Icarus is his attempt to escape from Crete by means of wings that his father constructed from feathers and wax. He ignored instructions not to fly too close to the sun, and the melting wax caused him to fall into the sea where he drowned.



- ✓ The area around Karaiskaki Square is known as **Metaxourghio** which took its name from the old silk factory (metaxi = silk), that has now been turned into a municipal gallery. Metaxourghio is one of the most socially and ethnically diverse neighborhoods of Athens. It owes its artistic resurgence to the efforts of individual artists and small-business owners, whose galleries, small theatres, and restaurants have helped to create this artistic atmosphere that now characterizes the area.



Monastiraki / Thession

(Line 1 & 3-Monastiraki Metro Station)

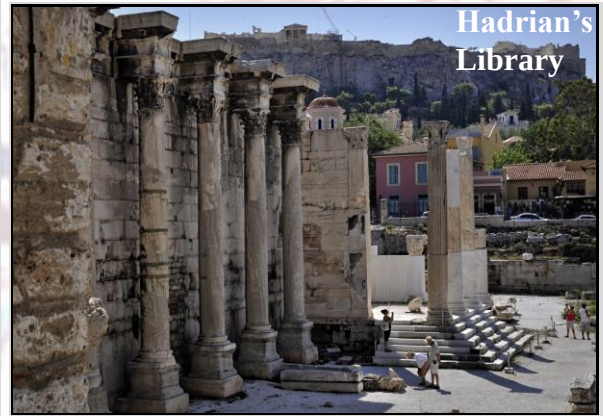
Bus Stop
14

- ✓ Visit the **ancient Greek agora** which was the commercial, political and cultural center of the city state of Athens. There you can visit, also, the temple of Hephaestus, which is the best preserved temple in Greece, and the little museum.



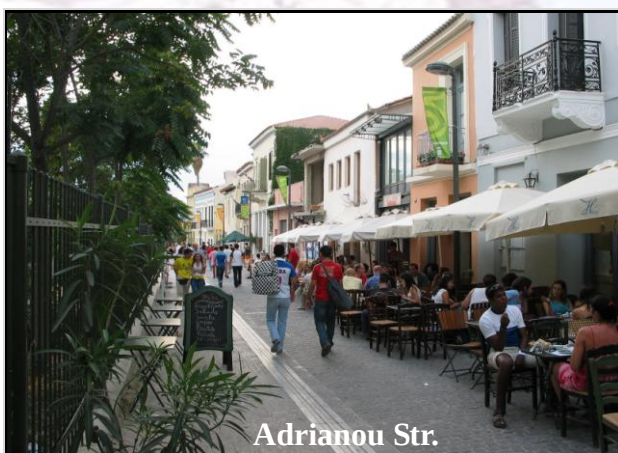
Ancient Agora

- ✓ Visit the **Hadrian's Library** with the beautiful Corinthian columns, the **Roman agora** and the **tower of the Winds**.



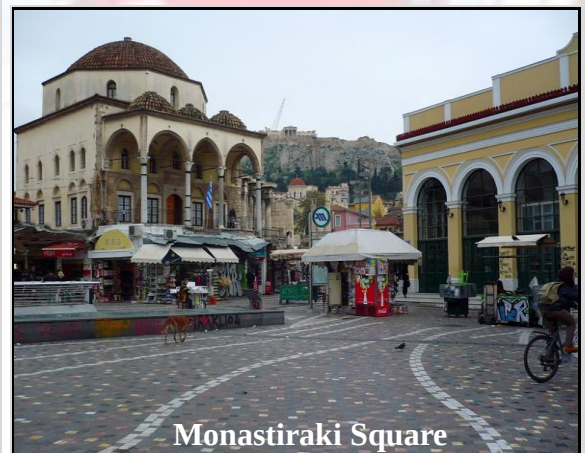
Hadrian's Library

- ✓ Right across the Hadrian's Library there is the **Adrianou Str.** which leads to Thession. On the way down you can find cafés and small restaurants with traditional Greek cuisine.



Adrianou Str.

- ✓ **Monastiraki** is the flea market where you can buy souvenirs and beautiful sandals made out of leather.



Monastiraki Square

Kotzia Square

(Line 2-Panepistimio Metro Station)

Bus Stop
15

- ✓ **City Hall of Athens:** A standard but ponderous neoclassical style edifice, designed in 1872. A tetrastyle prostyle porch in the Doric order dominates the façade.



- ✓ **Kotzia Square:** In the center of the fountain, stands a large abstract bronze sculpture made up of multiple curvilinear forms, which is surrounded by geyser. Constructions activities in the late 1980s revealed a section of ancient Athens. The visible remains below street level include 3 roads, pottery workshops, settling basins and cisterns from the Roman period and burials from the full sweep of the city's history.

- ✓ **Central or Municipal Market** (known as Varvakeios Agora): Walking down Athinas Str. you will meet the Central Market. On your right hand, there is the open-air vegetable and fruit market. On the other side, you will find the meat market and the main hall which is filled with fresh fish stalls. Whatever the sea offers, you can find it here!



Byzantine and Christian Museum

(Bus Stop 7 or Line 3-Evangelismos Metro Station)

This Museum can rightfully take pride in possessing one of the leading collections of Byzantine icons in the world. Its exhibits, that represent 1700 years of Byzantine art and architecture (3rd to 20th centuries), include 25,000 ecclesiastical objects from Greece, the Balkans,



Cyprus, Constantinople and Russia, classified in 11 collections: Sculptures, Mosaics, Frescoes, Replicas and the Loverdos' Collection (includes manuscripts, woodcarving crafts, vestments, portable icons etc). At the same time, the surrounding area of 17.5 acres, serves as a park with an open-air amphitheatre, gift shop, restaurant-café and recreational facilities. Presently, there are plans in consideration so that the above mentioned park would connect to the adjacent archaeological site of "Aristotle's

Lyceum" (that is the school where the philosopher taught since its establishment in 335 B.C until 323 B.C). The Museum also organizes significant temporary exhibitions as well as educational programs.



War Museum

(Bus Stop 7 or Line 3-Evangelismos Metro Station)

On display are weapons from the Stone Age and the Classical Period to the World War II. Amongst them there is a siege machine with a bridge and a ram dating back to the Hellenistic years, moreover, maps, flags, military uniforms and the models of warships and aircraft that are displayed, representing the entire spectrum of Greek history. In the front yard you will also find characteristic types of artillery guns, as well as various models of war aircraft, some of which you can enter.



Numismatic Museum

(Bus Stop 10 or Line 2-Panepistimio Metro Station)

It is one of the five most important numismatic museums in the world. It displays more than 600,000 coins, “treasures” (closed coin collections), standard weights, metals and precious stones, from the ancient Greek period, the Roman period, Byzantium, the western middle Ages, and modernity.



National Historical Museum

(Bus Stop 15 or Line 2-Panepistimio Metro Station)

It is located at Kolokotroni Square. The exhibits, displayed in 16 galleries, cover the period dating back to the last years prior to the fall of Constantinople (15th century) to the beginning of World War II; whereas the largest part of the exhibition pertains to the characters and historic events of the Greek revolution of 1821.



Metro Map



M1: Line 1 - Green Line

M2: Line 2 - Red Line

M3: Line 3 - Blue Line